BIO 005 · YUBA COLLEGE · FALL 2026

Human Physiology.

Course Syllabus · Section BIOL-5-D9286 · Sutter Internet (NET)

4.0 units · 15 weeks · September 8 to December 16, 2026

Fully online, lecture and lab · nothing meets at a set time · discussion posts Friday 10 pm, everything else Sunday 10 pm

C-ID BIOL 120B · IGETC 5B and 5C · CSU GE B2 and B3 · Transferable to CSU and UC

Read this first How the course runs, what is graded, and every date you need.

Keep it It is the agreement between us for the whole term.

Also in Canvas The Competency Packet, listing everything this course asks you to be able to do, and the course schedule.

Yuba College · Fall 2026 Dr. Sharilyn Rennie

01 Course identification and catalog data

Course	BIO 005, Human Physiology
Units	4.0 semester units
Section	BIOL-5-D9286 · Sutter Internet (NET)
Term	Fall 2026, 15 weeks. Instruction begins September 8, 2026. Term ends December 16, 2026.
Format	Fully online, lecture and lab, on your own time. Nothing in this course meets at a set time. Your initial discussion post is due Friday at 10 pm and everything else, including your two replies, is due Sunday at 10 pm.
Lecture instruction	Recorded concept lectures and slide decks in Canvas, worked against a weekly competency note sheet. This is where the content is taught.
Laboratory instruction	Weekly virtual labs in PhysioEx through Pearson, generating and interpreting real physiological output: traces, curves, values and calculations.
Instructor	Dr. Sharilyn Rennie
Level	Majors-level human physiology. Transfer-level laboratory science, taken by students heading into nursing, allied health, kinesiology and the biological sciences.
Prerequisite	BIOL 15 (Bioscience) or BIOL 1 (Principles of Biology). Recommended: eligibility for ENGL 1A and MATH 52, and basic computer skills.
Grading	Letter grade only. There is no Pass / No Pass option for this course.

Transfer	Transferable to both UC and CSU. IGETC Areas 5B and 5C. CSU GE Areas B2 and B3. C-ID BIOL 120B. Serves the Biology-Allied Health AS, Natural Science AS, Kinesiology AA-T, and the LVN-to-RN 30–Unit Option.

If you're heading toward nursing or another health program, check that program's specific requirements with a counselor. The contacts are in Section 15.

02 Instructor and contact

Instructor	Dr. Sharilyn Rennie
Email	srennie@yccd.edu
Best channel	Canvas Inbox. It keeps every course message in one place, which means I can find your history when you need me to.
Reply time	48 to 72 hours on weekdays. Please do not expect a same-day reply the night before a deadline.
Office hours	Wednesdays 9:00 to 10:00 am on Zoom. Drop in, no appointment needed. If that window never works with your schedule, message me and we will find another time.

Physiology builds on itself, so a small gap in September is a large one by November. Come and talk to me before you fall behind rather than after. That conversation is much easier for both of us while the gap is still small.

03 Course description and learning outcomes

Catalog description

Human Physiology introduces the physiological principles of function, integration, regulation and homeostasis of the human body. It includes topics at the molecular, cellular, tissue, and organ levels found within all eleven organ systems. Laboratory includes activities such as EEGs, EMGs, EKGs, blood tests, spirometric measurements, urinalysis, digestion experiments, and many others, simulated in this online section. The clinical aspects of evaluating and maintaining health are also discussed in lecture and laboratory.

This is a physiology course. We are after mechanism: what the body must accomplish, how it accomplishes it, and what happens when conditions change. Where anatomy appears, it appears because it explains a mechanism. What runs through all of it is clinical context, because a mechanism you have seen matter to a real patient is a mechanism you remember.

Student learning outcomes

By the end of this course you should be able to:

- **Critical thinking.** Collect, analyze and evaluate scientific data and show you understand it.
- **Scientific awareness.** Understand the purpose of scientific inquiry and how basic scientific principles and the scientific method apply.
- **Communication.** Use language and nonverbal communication to describe and present scientific data and results to an audience.

These three outcomes are the official ones. The **Competency Packet** in Canvas, 268 specific things you'll be able to do, each one a single skill, sits underneath them, and every exam question in this course traces back to that list. Nothing is graded that isn't on it. The third outcome, communication, is exactly what the draw-and-teach midterms practice.

04 How this course works

This is a fully online course, and the design is honest about what that means: nobody schedules your hours, so the course gives you a fixed weekly shape to pour them into. Your first meeting with every concept happens in the weekly **note sheet**, built from that week's competencies, worked against the reading and the concept lectures. The harder work, predicting, explaining, drawing a mechanism and teaching it out loud, is what the practice rounds and the midterms ask of you.

- **The note sheet is the pre-work.** One prompt for each thing you must be able to do that week. It comes first, always, and it doubles as your midterm study guide.
- **The lectures teach the content.** Recorded concept lectures and steppable slide decks, built to answer the questions the note sheet just made you ask.
- **The Mastery OS tracks your competencies** and runs spaced recall cards, ungraded, so you find out what you actually know before a grade depends on it.

- **Clinical Correlations** appear through the course: a real bedside exam on video, then questions asking you to explain the physiology that makes it work. The clinician's hands are the problem; the physiology is the answer.
- **The midterms are draw-and-teach.** You draw a physiological pathway and teach it on video, out loud, no notes, the way you'd teach a classmate. If you can teach it, you know it. Every week includes a five-minute ungraded rehearsal in exactly this format, so by Midterm 1 the format is familiar.

The one habit that makes this work: do the note sheet before anything else. Come to the lectures prepared and the problems, the labs and the practice rounds all click. Come in cold and none of them do.

05 The weekly rhythm

Every week follows the same five steps in the same order. Learn the shape once and the term runs on rails.

STEP	DO THIS
1 · Prepare	Open the week's note sheet and complete it from the assigned reading and the concept lectures. This comes first, always.
2 · Watch	Work through the week's lectures and slide decks with your note sheet beside you.
3 · Practice	Do the assigned book problems, and run your recall cards in the Mastery OS.
4 · Lab	Complete the week's PhysioEx lab and turn in your data record.
5 · Prove	Do the week's short draw-and-teach practice round. Five minutes, ungraded, exam format in miniature.

Two deadlines a week, and they do not move. Your discussion post is due **Friday at 10 pm**. Everything else, including your two discussion replies, is due **Sunday at 10 pm**. That holds all fifteen weeks.

The post comes earlier than the rest for one reason: nobody can reply to a post that is not there yet. A late post quietly takes the week away from the classmates who were going to respond to it, so that deadline is firmer than it looks.

Beyond those two times, you choose when in the week each step happens: five in the morning before work, nine at night after the kids are down, all day Saturday. The order above is the order that works; the schedule is yours.

06 Course materials and technology

Required

- **Canvas**, the college learning management system. You already have access through your Yuba account. Canvas is the system of record for this course.
- **Pearson Mastering A&P with PhysioEx.** Your labs run on it, and the eText of our book, **Human Physiology: An Integrated Approach** by Dee Unglaub Silverthorn, 9th edition, comes with it for free. **Buy it one way, the right way:** open our Canvas course, click **Access Pearson** in the left-hand menu, and purchase there. That path gives you the correct package at the best price, registered to our course automatically. Please don't buy access codes from Amazon or other websites. Many won't work with our course, can't be refunded, and are a waste of your money. You need this from the first week.
- **A device and reliable internet** that will run Canvas, Pearson and the Mastery OS, plus **a camera** (a phone is fine) for recording your draw-and-teach videos.
- **Paper and pens.** Homework in this course is handwritten and hand-drawn (Section 11), so you need a way to write, draw, and photograph or scan your work into a PDF for Canvas.

Free course tools, set up in Week 1

- **Mastery OS**, the study app. Browser-based and free. Tracks your competencies, runs spaced recall, and shows you where you are weak.
- **Concept lectures**, the recorded lecture videos and slide decks. This is where the content is taught.
- **The Competency Packet**, the full list of what this course asks of you and what it assumes you arrive with, with self-checks.

07 Grading and assessment

Five components. The work you can prove is your own carries the most weight, and no single piece is heavy enough to sink you on its own.

Note sheets	**20%**
Three midterms	**40%**
Lab	**15%**
Book problems	**15%**
Discussions	**10%**

COMPONENT	DETAIL	WEIGHT
Competency note sheets	15 weekly sheets, one prompt per competency. Five prompts graded for accuracy, the rest checked for completion.	20%
Midterm exams	3 exams, draw-and-teach on video. No notes. Mostly apply-and-reason, not pure recall.	40%
Laboratory	15 weekly PhysioEx labs with data records.	15%
Book problems	Assigned Silverthorn problems each week.	15%
Discussions	One post a week, carrying both the physiology and your thinking about it.	10%

Competency note sheets, 20 percent

- Every week's sheet is built directly from that week's competencies, one box per competency, and it is the first thing you do each week.
- **Two passes, two colours, in the same box.** The first pass comes from your textbook and your own notes, before you open any video. Organize what you can already put together and stop while half of every box is still empty. Then watch the week's videos, switch to a second

colour, and add into the same boxes what you were missing, what you had wrong, and what finally landed once you heard it explained.

- **Do not erase the first pass.** Leave it visible underneath, mistakes and all. Those marks are the most useful thing on the page, for you and for me.
- The two colours are how I can see which part of your understanding came from reading and which came from the videos. A sheet that arrives in a single colour has not finished the assignment, whatever is written on it, because it tells me the videos were skipped.
- Working in this order is not busywork. Arriving at a video already holding a half-built picture is what makes the video land, instead of washing over you while you nod along.
- You submit the whole sheet. I choose **five prompts** and grade those for accuracy, you won't know which five ahead of time, so every prompt has to be real. The rest is checked for completion.
- It doubles as your midterm study guide, so doing it well pays you twice.

Midterm exams, 40 percent

- These are not multiple-choice tests. Each midterm asks you to **draw a physiological pathway and teach it to me** on video, out loud, no notes: draw the mechanism, label it, explain each step and why it happens.
- If you can teach it, you know it. If you can only recognize it on a list of options, you don't, and this format is honest about the difference.
- **Midterm 1** covers Weeks 1 to 5: foundations, membranes, nerves. **Midterm 2** covers Weeks 6 to 10: muscle, hormones, the heart and circulation. **Midterm 3** covers Weeks 11 to 15: blood, digestion, breathing, the kidney, and putting it all together.
- You will not be surprised by the format: every week includes an ungraded rehearsal round in exactly this shape.

When the midterms are

Each midterm is a **window, not an hour**. It opens Monday at 8:00 am and closes Sunday at 10:00 pm, and you record and upload whenever inside it suits you. There is no proctoring software and no set sitting time. Diary all three now.

EXAM	COVERS	OPENS	CLOSES
Midterm 1	**Weeks 1 to 5**	**Mon Oct 12, 8:00 am**	**Sun Oct 18, 10:00 pm**
Midterm 2	**Weeks 6 to 10**	**Mon Nov 16, 8:00 am**	**Sun Nov 22, 10:00 pm**
Midterm 3	**Weeks 11 to 15**	**Mon Dec 14, 8:00 am**	**Wed Dec 16, 10:00 pm**

A midterm week is a lighter week. In Weeks 6, 11 and 15 your note sheet is still due Sunday, but that week's book problems and lab move to the following Sunday so the exam is not stacked on top of a full load. Week 15 is the exception: it is three days long, it is the exam, and nothing else is due.

Midterm 3 is not cumulative and it is not held in a separate finals week. It covers Weeks 11 to 15 and it closes when the term closes, Wednesday December 16.

Two dates worth putting together: Midterm 2 closes **Sunday November 22**, and the last day to drop with a W is **Saturday November 21**. That is deliberate on the college's calendar, not mine, so do not wait for a Midterm 2 grade to decide. On **Wednesday November 18** I post every current grade in the gradebook, with ten weeks of note sheets, problems, labs and discussions plus Midterm 1 already in it. That is your number for the drop decision, and Section 02 says how to reach me before it comes to that.

What I am actually grading

Most of the points in this course go to your reasoning, not to your final answer. That is not a softer standard, it is a harder one, and it is worth being specific about what it means before your first midterm.

Every graded assessment asks you to do one of three things: **draw the mechanism by hand**, **teach it out loud on video**, or **answer a question orally**. There is no format in this course where you pick a letter and move on. That is deliberate. Recognizing a correct answer among four options and being able to produce and defend one are different skills, and only the second one holds up at a bedside or in a program interview.

So when I read your work, a right answer with no reasoning behind it earns very little, and a wrong answer arrived at through sound physiological reasoning earns a great deal. If your logic is good and one step is off, you keep most of the credit and I will tell you exactly which step it was.

What that looks like in practice

Say a midterm asks: **a patient stands up quickly and their blood pressure briefly falls. Draw and explain what the body does about it.**

- **Little credit.** “The baroreceptor reflex fixes it.” True, and it tells me nothing about whether you understand the loop or just recognize its name.
- **Most of the credit.** A drawn loop showing pressure falling at the carotid sinus, the baroreceptors firing less, the medulla reading that drop, sympathetic outflow going up and parasympathetic going down, then heart rate, contractility and vessel diameter changing, and pressure coming back up. Each arrow labeled with what is actually moving and in which direction, explained out loud as you draw it.
- **Also most of the credit.** The same drawing, explained the same way, but you have the baroreceptors increasing their firing rate when pressure drops instead of decreasing it. The direction of one arrow is wrong. Everything around it, the structure of the loop, the integrating center, the effectors, the correction, is right. You lose the points for that step and keep the rest, and I will tell you where it went sideways.
- **No credit.** A perfect textbook diagram you cannot talk through when I ask you what the integrating center is doing.

The third case is the one students find surprising, so I want to say it plainly: getting a detail wrong inside good reasoning is a normal part of learning physiology, and this course is built so that it costs you a little rather than a lot. What costs you is not reasoning at all.

Laboratory, 15 percent

- One PhysioEx lab every week, aligned with that week's lecture material. You generate and interpret real physiological output: a trace, a curve, a set of values, a calculation.

Book problems, 15 percent

- Assigned problems from the Silverthorn chapters you read each week, the calculations and predict-and-explain reasoning the midterms ask for. Problem numbers are on each week's page.

Discussions, 10 percent

- **One post a week, not two.** Each post does two jobs at once: it works through something from that week's physiology, and it says something honest about your own thinking on that same material. Not a content post and a separate reflection post, one post that carries both.
- The second half is the part students tend to skip, so here is what it looks like. Where did your prediction turn out to be wrong, and what were you assuming that made it seem right? What did you have to go back and re-learn? Which part still feels shaky when you try to explain it without looking?

- You reply to two classmates. A reply that adds a mechanism, catches an error, or asks a real question is worth writing. One that says you agree is not.
- This is closed to AI. The whole point is what your reasoning actually looked like this week, and that is not something a model can report on your behalf.

08 Grading scale and the workload

Fixed scale, applied to your final weighted percentage. There is no curve.

Grade	Range
A	89.5 to 100%
B	79.5 to 89.4%
C	69.5 to 79.4%
D	59.5 to 69.4%
F	0 to 59.4%

The workload, honestly

California community colleges follow the Carnegie standard, and by the official course outline this 4-unit course is **216 learning hours**: 144 hours of instruction plus 72 of study. Over our 15 weeks, that's an official floor of about **14 hours a week**. A floor is what it takes to pass, roughly, it is not a promise of what it takes to do well.

Realistically, plan on 16 to 20 hours a week to genuinely learn this material: to walk into a midterm able to draw a pathway and teach it with no notes, not just recognize it.

If you need an A or a B, budget 20 hours, and sometimes closer to 30. Most of you are headed for nursing or other health programs that require an A or B in this course; a C won't get you in. What it actually takes depends on the grade you're going for, your experience as a student, and your background. If you haven't had anatomy yet, or you're taking it at the same time as this course, you'll be teaching yourself the parts of the body on your own time while learning how they work in mine, and that's real added hours. The Competency Packet lists exactly what the course assumes you arrive with, so you can see your own gaps in Week 1 instead of discovering them in Week 6.

I would rather you knew all of this in September than discovered it in October. Load the early weeks heavily. Physiology compounds, and so does falling behind in it. This is a mastery-based course: attending and turning things in does not by itself earn the grade. The study hours are what do.

09 Course schedule

15 weeks, three midterms. Each midterm closes a five-week block. Week titles below are what you'll see in Canvas; the reading and assignments for each week are on that week's page.

WK	OPENS	WEEK
1	Sep 8	How physiology works and what keeps you steady
2	Sep 14	The chemistry that does work in the body
3	Sep 21	Getting across the membrane
4	Sep 28	How cells talk, and the electrical signal
5	Oct 5	Synapses and central integration
Midterm 1 · Weeks 1 to 5 · window Mon Oct 12, 8:00 am to Sun Oct 18, 10:00 pm		
6	Oct 12	Sensing the world, and the responses you do not control
7	Oct 19	Muscle, and how movement gets commanded
8	Oct 26	Hormones and reproduction, the slow control system
9	Nov 2	The heart as a pump
10	Nov 9	Pressure, flow, and holding blood pressure steady
Midterm 2 · Weeks 6 to 10 · window Mon Nov 16, 8:00 am to Sun Nov 22, 10:00 pm		
11	Nov 16	Blood and how the body defends itself
12	Nov 23	Digestion, and how you use food for fuel · Thanksgiving week, plan ahead
13	Nov 30	Breathing, gas transport, and the fast pH lever
14	Dec 7	The kidney and body fluid balance
15	Dec 14	The slow pH lever, and putting it all together · three days only
Midterm 3 · Weeks 11 to 15 · window Mon Dec 14, 8:00 am to Wed Dec 16, 10:00 pm		

If a date has to move I will announce it in Canvas. Grade weights and exam policy will not change.

10 Attendance, participation and enrollment

In an online course, participation is submitted work. There is no roll call. The weekly note sheet is the heartbeat. If it's coming in, you're attending; staying enrolled and staying current are the same thing here.

- **Week 1 is mandatory.** Turn in Week 1's work. A student who submits nothing in the first weeks can be dropped as a no-show, and the seat goes to the waitlist.
- **Census is September 27.** I certify who is actively participating. If nothing has come in by then, I am required to report you as not attending, and you can be dropped. Don't let a registration date end your semester in Week 3.
- **Get into Canvas at least three times a week** and turn on announcement notifications, because that is where a schedule change or an exam-window note appears first.

Dropping the course is yours to do

If you decide to leave the course, you have to formally drop it yourself through your student portal. Do not assume I have done it for you, and do not assume it happens on its own. A course you walked away from but never dropped becomes an F you did not need to earn. The Fall 2026 deadlines are in Section 14.

11 Academic integrity and the use of AI

Academic honesty

Cheating and plagiarism are not tolerated in this course. A violation earns at least a zero on the work in question, may result in an F for the course, and is reported for disciplinary action under college policy. Complete your own work, and ask me if you are not sure where the line falls. Asking is always the cheaper option.

Handwritten means handwritten

Unless an assignment says otherwise, everything you turn in is handwritten and hand-drawn. Typed work earns a zero.

This isn't nostalgia. Drawing a pathway by hand is how your brain builds it, and it's how the midterms work, so it's how the practice works. Read the directions on every assignment before you start; work that ignores the directions can't be redone.

How I use AI, so you know where it sits

I am asking you to be careful with AI, and that would be hollow if I were not straight with you about my own use of it. So here it is.

AI did not write this course. I have been teaching human physiology for over ten years. The explanations, the sequence, the competencies, the questions and the way this material fits together were written by me, rewritten by me, and rewritten again after watching where students actually got stuck. That is hundreds of hours of work, and honestly probably thousands, built up over a decade of teaching this subject.

What AI does here is build things. The interactive tools, the worksheets, the games, the flashcards and the spaced recall system all take coding that I do not write myself. I describe what I want you to be able to do, and what should happen when you get it wrong, and AI helps me construct the thing that does it. It works more like a very fast workshop assistant than like an author.

Why that matters to you. Those tools are built around what the evidence actually says helps people learn: retrieval practice, spacing your work out over time, drawing from memory, and explaining out loud. I could describe those methods for years without being able to build software that delivers them. Now I can build it, and you are the one who gets the benefit.

What has not changed is that the physiology is mine and the teaching is mine. When you read an explanation on one of these pages, that is me talking to you.

Using AI

For studying, AI is encouraged. Tools like ChatGPT and Claude are useful for the same things a good study partner is useful for: explaining a concept a second way, quizzing you, helping you plan your week. Teaching a concept to something that asks follow-up questions is one of the better ways to find out whether you actually have it.

For graded work, the rules are strict. What you turn in must be your own work, in your own hand, from your own head. Turning in AI-written work as yours is cheating, and no outside help of any kind is allowed during exams.

Here's the honest reason, beyond the rules: the midterms are half your grade, and they're you, on camera, teaching with no notes. A tool that does your weekly work for you is quietly taking the practice you'll desperately want back in exam week. Nobody can outsource their own understanding.

No extra credit

There's no individual extra credit, and asking for it won't create any. If I ever offer extra credit, I offer it to the whole class at once.

12 Due dates, late work and make-ups

Initial discussion posts are due Friday at 10 pm. Everything else, replies included, is due Sunday at 10 pm. Up to 24 hours late: automatic 50% reduction. After 24 hours: zero, no make-up. There are no exceptions, not for family, travel, work, or other obligations.

Genuine emergencies are the exception to that, and they are handled case by case. Message me as early as you can rather than after the fact.

I know that sounds strict, so here is the honest reasoning. This course never requires you to be anywhere at any particular time. You can do every bit of this work at whatever hour of whatever day fits your life, and the material is posted **weeks ahead**. That means the cushion for life's surprises is built in before the deadline, not after it. If you know a trip, a busy stretch at work, or a family event is coming, work ahead the week before. If something unexpected lands on a Saturday, the week's work shouldn't have been waiting on that Saturday.

This is the trade the course asks of you: total freedom over your hours, in exchange for full responsibility for them. Nobody takes attendance, so nobody rescues a deadline either. Students who pick their work times at the start of the week and protect them do very well here. Students who plan to "find time Sunday" usually find something else instead.

Submit early. The internet fails, computers crash, and files refuse to upload, always at 11:58 pm. A submission that exists on Thursday can't be lost on Sunday.

If something serious happens in your life, come and talk to me about your options in the course as a whole, including the withdrawal deadline in Section 14. What I can't do is reopen a deadline for one student that everyone else met under the same conditions.

13 Accessibility and accommodation

Your success matters to me. This course is designed to be welcoming to and usable by everyone: English-language learners, students with disabilities, students returning to school after time away, and students new to online courses. If any part of the course gets in the way of your learning, tell me as soon as possible and we will build strategies together.

Office	Disabled Student Programs & Services (DSPS), Building 1800, Marysville campus
Phone	(530) 741-6795
Email	dspsinfo@yccd.edu
Fax	(530) 741-6942

Yuba College provides reasonable accommodations for students with documented disabilities under the ADA and Section 504. Apply with DSPS, submit your documentation, and schedule an intake appointment by phone, Zoom, or in person; you never have to come to campus.

Set this up in Week 1. You are responsible for sending me your approved accommodations early in the term. Accommodations are not retroactive, so work you have already submitted cannot be re-graded under accommodation. Your information stays confidential; I only ever see the approved accommodation, never the paperwork behind it. Accommodations adjust how you show what you know, never what the course asks of you.

14 Registration deadlines and important dates

These dates govern your enrollment, your money, and your transcript. Diary them today.

DATE	DEADLINE
Mon Sep 8	Instruction begins. Week 1 opens.
Mon Oct 12 to Sun Oct 18	**Midterm 1 window. Weeks 1 to 5. Closes Sunday Oct 18 at 10:00 pm.**
Sun Sep 27	**Census.** Participation is certified from submitted work. No work in means being reported as not attending, and possibly dropped.
Wed Nov 18	**Every grade posted.** Ten weeks of work plus Midterm 1. This is the number to use for the drop decision.
Sat Nov 21	**Last day to drop with a W**, without academic penalty. After this date you receive a letter grade, whatever it is.
Mon Nov 16 to Sun Nov 22	**Midterm 2 window. Weeks 6 to 10. Closes Sunday Nov 22 at 10:00 pm.**
Mon Dec 14 to Wed Dec 16	**Midterm 3 window. Weeks 11 to 15. Closes Wednesday Dec 16 at 10:00 pm.**
Wed Dec 16	Term ends. Final work is due.

Check your schedule bill in your student portal for any class-specific add, refund, and no-record drop deadlines, those dates come from Admissions and Records, and short-term sections run on their own calendar. November 21 is the one people miss. If this course is not going to work out, the difference between deciding on November 20 and deciding on November 22 is the difference between a W and an F on your transcript forever, and Section 02 tells you how to reach me before it comes to that.

15 Student support, and where to find help

Start with me: Canvas Inbox, email, or Wednesday office hours. For everything else, these are real offices with real people, already paid for by your enrollment, and almost all of them work with you online.

- **Counseling.** Academic, career, and personal counseling, with online appointments. (530) 634–7766 · yubacounseling@yccd.edu · yc.yccd.edu/student/counseling

- **Tutoring.** Free through the college, in person and online, including at the Sutter County Center. (530) 751-5558 · yc.yccd.edu/student/tutoring
- **DSPS.** Accommodations and disability services. (530) 741-6795 · dspsinfo@yccd.edu. See Section 13.
- **EOPS/CARE.** Counseling, books, and services for eligible students. (530) 741-6995 · yceops@yccd.edu
- **Basic needs.** Dusty's Food Pantry and Basic Needs can help with food, housing, and more. If you are hungry or unsure where you are sleeping, start here. It will not change how I grade you. yc.yccd.edu/student/dustys-food-pantry

If you're in crisis. If it's a life-threatening emergency, call **911** or go to the nearest emergency room. The **988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline** is free, confidential, and answers 24/7: call or text 988. Sutter-Yuba Behavioral Health runs 24-hour local crisis services: **(530) 673-8255** or toll-free **(888) 923-3800**. During business hours, Yuba College Counseling can also help: (530) 634-7766.

Physiology can wait. You matter more than any deadline in this course. Reach out, and then message me and we'll sort the rest.

This syllabus

This syllabus is the course agreement between us for Fall 2026, written to be consistent with the approved Course Outline of Record for BIOL 5 and with college policy. Where a course rule here and a college policy could be read differently, college policy governs. I may adjust dates or activities as the term goes and will announce any change in Canvas. Grade weights and exam policy will not change.

16 A final word

Prepare, keep the rhythm, and submit early.

This course asks real work, and I will not pretend otherwise. But the design is on your side. Every week has the same five steps in the same order. The note sheet meets every idea before it's tested, the practice rounds rehearse the exam format until it's familiar, and the recall cards tell you what you actually know before a grade depends on it. Nothing in this course is a surprise. The whole of it is published in the Competency Packet on day one.

Keep the weekly rhythm, do the prepare step, and reach out early when you need help. Your grade is feedback, not a verdict. Keep showing up, and keep going. I am rooting for you.

Dr. Sharilyn Rennie
Yuba College

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